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What would it take to make someone want to leave behind all the comforts and venture alone into the wilderness? To look for freedom and what it's like beyond societal expectations. Well, the book *Into the Wild* explains and shows the story of Chris McCandless that continues to cause people to debate if he was a person that should be idolized or someone who made bad choices and was just a reckless idiot, as people claim he was. McCandless was raised in an upper-middle-class family. His father would take him camping; he had a passion for camping and would often go on solo camping trips and enjoy the outdoors and living simply in nature. He wanted to escape society's pressures. Chris McCandless's journey was a path that was displayed as bravery for freedom but brought risks by his lack of experience and idealistic faith. In general, Chris McCandless should be admired for his courage and his commitment to living honestly by his best ideas.

Chris McCandless believed that living a life true to his beliefs was more important than living up to society's expectations. Chris McCandless was unaware of the risks and harsh realities of the wilderness. His lack of preparation was eventually the cause of his tragic consequences on his journey. He just knew he wanted to explore the wilderness and wanted

freedom; maybe if he had been prepared for his journey, he would've lived, but at least he did it doing what he loved. He also believed he could survive with a ten-pound bag of rice. He barely had any equipment for survival. Krakauer writes about how McCandless "was a hard worker and didn't complain" (pdf 17) and would show courage in difficult situations. This quote explains how Chris's journey was not as reckless as he's spoken about: "You could tell right away that Alex was intelligent" (pdf 17). as Westerberg claimed. Eventually, Chris's courage to follow his beliefs, despite the risk and the hardship he would face, was determined; it revealed the type of person he was, who was worthy and should have been respected. In this way, Chris's bravery and determination highlight the remarkable traits that defined him during his journey to find peace.

Chris McCandless believed that happiness and freedom could come from living simply and rejecting material goods. He was inspired by writers like Henry David Thoreau, who was known for staying in a cabin for two years near Walden Pond to experience a "deliberate" life. and Leo Tolstoy, who was known for epic novels like *War and Peace* and *Anna Karenina*. Krakauer points this out by quoting Thoreau's words, which Chris had highlighted: "Rather than love, than money, rather than fame, give me truth" (pdf 90). This quote explains how McCandless actions were all based on morals to live a truthful life and value yourself. Therefore, as a result, his journey was an active attempt to live up to his principles rather than just an escape. McCandless questioned traditional beliefs and pursued a

life of honesty and meaning by embracing such deep ideals. His dedication to these principles shows a maturity of personality that is worthy of respect and appreciation.

Through McCandless adventures in the outdoors, Chris always valued personal freedom and self-discovery. He left his family in order for him to live alone and discover nature and push himself to his limit and discover more about himself. His perspective on life shaped his journey, which was not only physically demanding but also deeply reflective. Krakauer, for example, notes that McCandless wanted “ To become lost in the wild” (pdf 123) to escape the trappings of modern life. This sentence shows McCandless' strong desire to completely lose himself in nature and escape from everything. He accepted the uncertainty and isolation as a necessary part of his journey for self-awareness by attempting to become lost. As a result, his capacity to take risks, to show a strong commitment to leading, and to gain experience based on his personal growth is limited. Therefore, McCandless' attempt at self-discovery through wilderness exposure is a great way and example of dedication to living a genuine life and exploring deeper aspects of reality.

Chris McCandless journey across the wilderness is an outstanding example of the endurance of the human spirit and his commitment. His courage in the face of adversity challenges, his dedication to maintaining his firm beliefs and his search for personal growth through isolation all show a personality motivated by sincerity and his purpose. Instead of simply Rejecting society, McCandless pursued a life of joy characterized by independence and

personal development. His story is both captivating and deserving of appreciation because of these characteristics.